



restaurant

DROPOUT

SPRING RECIPES 2025



THIS WEEK'S MENU

Ranch Cutlets

with an Herbed Spring Vegetable Medley

buttermilk-brined chicken, finely chopped herbs, cucumbers, snap peas, blanched asparagus, feta, baby gem lettuce, simple lemon vinaigrette

Boursin Butter Salmon

with Buttermilk Mashed Potatoes

seared salmon fillets, boursin butter, mashed Yukon gold potatoes, blanched asparagus, buttermilk, dill, chives, flaky salt

Grilled Peppercorn-Marinated Steak

with Creme Fraiche Baked Potatoes

peppercorn marinated steak, asparagus spears, baked Yukon gold potatoes, crème fraîche, chives, pepper, flaky salt

Charred Cabbage

with Herby Butter Bean Salad

charred cabbage, herbed crème fraîche sauce, butter beans, simple lemon vinaigrette, blanched asparagus, snap peas, dill, feta, mint, chives

Lemony White Fish

Crème Fraîche Butter Beans & Charred Baby Gems

white fish fillets, sliced lemon, butter beans, herbed crème fraîche sauce, charred baby gems, feta, simple lemon vinaigrette, chives, flaky salt

Buttermilk Biscuits served fresh on the side



GROCERY LIST

Produce

- Garlic (4 cloves)¹²³⁴⁵
- Sugar Snap Peas (8 oz)¹⁴⁵
- English Cucumber (1 - optional)¹⁴
- Asparagus (1 ½ to 2 bunches)¹²³⁴
- Lemon (3)¹³⁴⁵
- Baby Gem Lettuce (2-3 hearts)¹⁵
- Yukon Gold Potatoes (8 medium)²³
- Cabbage (1/2 head)^{4*}
- Dill (1 large bunch)¹²⁴
- Chives (2 bunches)¹²³⁴⁵
- Mint (1 small bunch)¹⁴

Shelf-Stable Goods

- Butter Beans (2 15-ounce cans)⁴⁵
- Panko Breadcrumbs (1 cup)¹
- Chicken or Vegetable Stock (1/2 cup)⁴

Eggs & Dairy

- Eggs (1)¹
- Buttermilk (16 oz)¹²³⁴⁵
- Crème Fraîche (8 oz)¹³⁴⁵

Cheese

- Feta (8 oz)¹⁴⁵
- Garlic & Fine Herbs Boursin Cheese (5.3 oz)²³

Suggested Proteins

- 1-2 large (8-9 oz) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breasts (1 optional)¹⁴
- 2 (4 oz) Tilapia Fillets⁵
- 2 (4 oz) Salmon Fillets²
- 1 (10-12 oz) NY Strip Steak³

KEY

- ¹ = Ranch Cutlets
- ² = Boursin Butter Salmon
- ³ = Grilled Steak
- ⁴ = Charred Cabbage
- ⁵ = Lemony White Fish
- *=rollover ingredient



ESSENTIALS

& TIME SAVERS

Essentials

Fats

- Olive Oil¹³⁴⁵
- Neutral Oil¹²³
- Salted Butter²⁴⁵
- Unsalted Butter²³

Acid/Vinegar

- White Wine Vinegar¹³⁴⁵

Spices & Aromatics

- Black Pepper (& Peppercorns)¹²³⁴⁵

Other

- Kosher Salt¹²³⁴⁵
- White Cane Sugar¹³⁴⁵
- Honey¹⁴⁵
- Dijon Mustard¹³⁴⁵
- All-Purpose Flour¹
- Flaky Salt²³⁵

KEY

¹ = Ranch Cutlets

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PREP LIST

KEY

- ¹ = Ranch Cutlets
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 = used in "prepped ingredient"

Green = keep out during prep

□ Prep Produce

- Cabbage (1/2 head; slice into 2 wedges)⁴
- Cucumber (1; peel, deseed, & chop [into half moons] optional)¹⁴
- Snap Peas (8 oz; slice/chop at a diagonal)¹⁴⁵
- Asparagus (1 1/2-2 bunches; remove the fibrous ends)¹²³⁴
- Baby Gem Lettuce (2-3 hearts; slice in half, wash, & dry)¹⁵
- Lemon (2; slice in half) 
- Herbs (store separately)
 - Dill (1 bunch; finely chop)¹²⁴⁵ 
 - Chives (1 bunch; finely chop)¹²³⁴⁵ 
 - Mint (1 bunch; pick leaves)¹⁴
- Garlic (4 cloves; peel)⁴ 

CLEANING BREAK

- Boil Yukon Gold Potatoes (Place 8-9 potatoes in a large pot and cover with cold water. Bring to a boil and cook until fork tender)²³
- Strain Butter Beans (& put away)⁴⁵
- Create Blanching Station (see Substack Note in 'Mise en Place')
- Crumble Feta¹⁴⁵
- Prepare Peppercorn Marinade (See PDF 'Peppercorn Marinade')³
- Blanch Sugar Snap Peas (1/2 cup)¹⁴⁵ & Asparagus (3/4 of the bunch)¹²³⁴
- Finish Sauces
 - Herbed Crème Fraîche Sauce (See PDF 'Herbed Crème Fraîche Sauce')¹³⁴⁵
 - Buttermilk Brine (See PDF 'Buttermilk Brine')¹⁴
 - Simple Lemon Vinaigrette (See PDF 'Simple Lemon Vinaigrette')¹⁴⁵
 - Boursin Butter (See PDF 'Boursin Butter')²³

OPTIONAL ADDITIONAL PREP

- Prepare Buttermilk Biscuits (see Substack - Dessert Menu 'Buttermilk Biscuits')¹³⁴⁵
- Chicken Breasts (1-2 large; slice in half, lengthwise [creating cutlets])¹ 2nd breast is optional⁴
 - Store proteins in airtight bags in the freezer - the night before intended use, transfer to the refrigerator to thaw overnight



RANCH CUTLETS

WITH AN HERBED SPRING VEGETABLE MEDLEY

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Buttermilk Brine (Page 6)¹⁴

Herbed Crème Fraîche Sauce (Page 9)^{134s}

Simple Lemon Vinaigrette (Page 7)^{14s}

Buttermilk Biscuits (see The Dessert Menu 'Buttermilk Biscuits')^{134s}

Ranch Cutlets

1 batch* of Buttermilk Brine

1 large (8-9 oz) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breast, sliced in half (lengthwise)

½ cup All-Purpose Flour

Kosher Salt

1 Egg

1 cup Panko Breadcrumbs

1 Tbsp chopped Dill

1 Tbsp chopped Chives

Freshly Ground Black Pepper

High Smoke Point Neutral Oil, *for frying*

Herbed Crème Fraîche Sauce, *for serving*

**See Substack Note in 'Mise en Place'*

Herbed Spring Vegetable Medley

3-4 blanched Asparagus Spears, chopped (1")

1 heart of Baby Gem Lettuce, torn into bite-sized pieces

¼ cup crumbled Feta Cheese

6-7 Mint Leaves, hand torn

A pinch of chopped Dill

½ cup chopped and blanched Sugar Snap Peas

½ cup seeded and chopped Cucumbers (optional)

Simple Lemon Vinaigrette, *to taste*

Kosher Salt, *to taste*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, *to taste*

Accompaniments

2 freshly baked Buttermilk Biscuits (optional)

Instructions

Brine Chicken

1. In a small mixing bowl, combine **buttermilk brine** and **chicken breast**. Rest for at least 30 minutes at room temperature or up to 8 hours in the refrigerator.

Assemble & Cook the Ranch Chicken Cutlets

1. Pat chicken dry with a paper towel, before placing in a shallow bowl. In the same shallow bowl, coat the chicken in **flour** and a **pinch of salt**.
2. In a separate shallow bowl, whisk the **egg**; in a final shallow bowl, mix together **panko breadcrumbs**, **dill**, **chives**, a generous pinch of **salt**, and **pepper**.
2. Coat your **chicken breasts** in flour, then, place in the egg mixture, fully coating both sides. Transfer the egg-coated chicken breast into the breadcrumb mixture, pressing the breadcrumbs onto the surface area of the chicken breast.
3. Heat enough **neutral oil** to cover the bottom of a large cast-iron skillet over medium heat (oil filling ¼ inch up the side of the pan preferred).
4. Once the oil is 375°F-400°F, add chicken cutlets. Cook the chicken cutlets on both sides until golden brown and crispy—3 to 4 minutes per side. Once the internal temperature of the chicken reaches 165°F, transfer each cutlet to a paper towel-lined plate and season with a pinch of salt.
5. Allow the chicken to rest for 3-4 minutes before serving.

Hot Tip: Start preparing the Herbed Spring Vegetable Medley while the cutlet rests.

Prepare Herbed Spring Vegetable Medley & Plate Dish

1. In a medium mixing bowl, combine **asparagus**, **lettuce**, **feta**, **mint**, **dill**, **sugar snap peas**, and **cucumber** (optional). Toss until well combined. Add **lemon vinaigrette** and **salt** to taste, and stir.
2. Spread a dollop of **herbed crème fraîche** onto each serving plate and top with a chicken cutlet. Plate the herbed spring vegetable medley next to the cutlet and garnish with **pepper**. Serve with warm **buttermilk biscuits** (optional).

BOURSIN BUTTER SALMON WITH BUTTERMILK MASHED POTATOES

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients



Boursin Butter (Page 8)²³

Buttermilk Mashed Potatoes

4 cooked Yukon Gold Potatoes

¾ cup Buttermilk

3 Tbsp Salted Butter

Kosher Salt, to taste

Boursin Butter Salmon

2 (4 oz) Salmon Fillets

Kosher Salt

Freshly Ground Black Pepper

Neutral Oil

12-14 Blanched Asparagus Spears

½ batch of Boursin Butter, heated*

**see note on Substack in 'A Few Quick Notes'*

Accompaniments

Chopped Chives, *for garnish*

Chopped Dill, *for garnish*

Freshly Ground Black Pepper

Flaky Salt (optional)

Instructions

Boil the Potatoes

1. Bring a medium pot of water up to a boil.
2. Once the water begins to boil, add cooked **potatoes** and cook until fully heated through, about 4-5 minutes.

Hot Tip: While potatoes cook, prepare the asparagus & salmon.

Prepare the Asparagus & Salmon

1. Season **salmon fillets** with **salt** and **pepper**. Set aside.
2. Heat a medium pan over high heat and add **neutral oil**. Add **blanched asparagus** and a pinch of salt. Sauté until lightly seared on all sides, about 3-4 minutes. Remove the asparagus from the skillet and plate.
3. In the now-empty skillet, add another 1 to 2 glugs of neutral oil.
4. Place the seasoned salmon fillets presentation-side facing down. Cook until golden and crisp, then flip and finish cooking to your preferred doneness.

Assemble the Buttermilk Mashed Potatoes

1. Drain the cooked potatoes and return them to the pot. Add **buttermilk**, **butter**, and a couple generous pinches of **salt**. Mash until smooth and creamy and cook, while stirring, over medium-high heat, until fully heated through. Season with additional salt to taste, if needed.

Plate and Serve

1. Spoon a bed of mashed potatoes onto the plate, next to the cooked asparagus. Top with the cooked salmon. Dollop a large spoonful of **boursin butter** on each cooked salmon fillet and garnish with **chives**, **dill**, **freshly ground black pepper**, and **flaky salt** (optional).

GRILLED PEPPERCORN-MARINATED STEAK WITH CRÈME FRAÎCHE BAKED POTATOES

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients



Peppercorn Marinade (Page 10)³

Boursin Butter (Page 8)²³

Herbed Crème Fraîche Sauce (Page 9)¹³⁴⁵

Buttermilk Biscuits (see The Dessert Menu 'Buttermilk Biscuits')¹³⁴⁵

Grilled Steak & Asparagus

10-12 oz New York Strip Steak

1 batch of Peppercorn Marinade

14-16 Asparagus Spears

Olive Oil

Kosher Salt

½ batch of Boursin Butter, *for serving*

Crème Fraîche Potatoes

4 cooked Yukon Gold Potatoes

Olive Oil

Kosher Salt

2 Tbsp Herbed Crème Fraîche

Chives

Flaky Salt

Freshly Ground Black Pepper

Accompaniments

2 freshly baked Buttermilk Biscuits (optional)

Instructions

Marinate the Steak

1. Place the **steak** in a small bowl and cover with the **peppercorn marinade**. Marinate for at least 30 minutes at room temperature or up to 4 hours in the refrigerator.

Prepare the Potatoes

1. Preheat your oven to 400°F.
2. Place **cooked potatoes** on a parchment-lined sheet tray and lightly coat in **olive oil** and **salt**. Bake for 15 minutes.

Hot Tip: While potatoes bake, prepare the steak & asparagus.

Prepare the Steak & Asparagus

1. Preheat your grill on high heat and lightly **oil** the grill grates.
2. Lightly season **asparagus** with **olive oil** and **salt** and place on the grill to begin cooking.
3. Pat the marinated steak down with a paper towel—to *remove most excess moisture*—then place directly on the grill to cook for 4-5 minutes, or until a crust forms. Flip and continue grilling until the steak reaches your desired doneness (130°F-135°F for medium-rare; 140°F-145°F for medium; 150°F-155°F for medium-well).
4. Transfer the cooked steak and asparagus to a plate and cover loosely with foil. Rest for 5 minutes.

Assemble the Final Dish

1. Remove the baked potatoes from the oven and plate. Using a sharp knife, cut two even cross cuts on the top of the potatoes, opening them up. Place a dollop of **crème fraîche** in each potato and garnish with **chives**, **flaky salt**, and **pepper**. Serve alongside the grilled asparagus.
2. Slice the steak, across the grain, and plate directly next to the asparagus. Top the steak with a dollop of **boursin butter**. Serve with freshly baked **buttermilk biscuits** on the side (optional)

CHARRED CABBAGE WITH HERBY BUTTER BEAN SALAD

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Buttermilk Brine (Page 6)¹⁴ *Optional*

Herbed Crème Fraîche Sauce (Page 9)¹³⁴⁵

Simple Lemon Vinaigrette (Page 7)¹⁴⁵

Buttermilk Biscuits (see The Dessert Menu 'Buttermilk Biscuits')¹³⁴⁵

Charred Cabbage

Neutral, High-Smoke Point Oil (e.g., Avocado oil)

½ head of Cabbage, sliced into wedges

Kosher Salt

Freshly Ground Black Pepper

2 Tbsp Salted Butter

1 clove of Garlic, grated

½ cup Chicken or Vegetable Stock

⅓ cup Buttermilk Brine (optional)

1 large (8-9 oz) Boneless Skinless Chicken Breast, sliced in half lengthwise (optional)

3-4 Tbsp Herbed Crème Fraîche Sauce, for garnish

Chopped Dill, for garnish

Herby Butter Bean Salad

15 oz can (about 1 ½ cups) rinsed and strained Butter Beans

A pinch of chopped Dill

A pinch of chopped Chives

5-6 Mint Leaves, hand torn

3-4 blanched Asparagus Spears, chopped (1")

⅓ cup chopped and blanched Sugar Snap Peas

Remaining seeded & chopped Cucumber (optional)

¼ cup crumbled Feta Cheese

Simple Lemon Vinaigrette, to taste

Kosher Salt, to taste

Freshly Ground Black Pepper, to taste

2 freshly baked Buttermilk Biscuits (optional)

Instructions

Optional Brine the Chicken

1. In a small mixing bowl, combine **buttermilk brine** and **chicken breast**. Rest for at least 30 minutes at room temperature or up to 8 hours in the refrigerator.

Prepare the Charred Cabbage

1. Heat **neutral oil** in a large skillet over high heat. Once the oil is hot and shimmering, add **cabbage wedges**. Season with **salt** and **pepper** and cook for 3 to 4 minutes, undisturbed.
2. Flip the cabbage and continue cooking for an additional 3 to 4 minutes.
3. **If preparing chicken...** move cabbage wedges to the side of the skillet and add a couple glugs of neutral oil to the now-empty side of the skillet. Pat the brined chicken down with a paper towel and place directly onto the hot oil. Sear, untouched, for 2-3 minutes, until a golden brown crust forms. Flip the chicken and continue cooking as instructed below.
4. Add **butter** to the skillet. Once the butter is fully melted, add **grated garlic** and cook just until fragrant (about 10-15 seconds). Slowly pour in **stock** and boil on high heat for 45 seconds to 1 minute. Reduce the heat to low, cover, and finish cooking for 5-6 minutes while you prepare the herby butter bean salad.

Prepare the Herby Butter Bean Salad & Plate

1. In a large mixing bowl, combine **butter beans, dill, chives, mint, asparagus, sugar snap peas, cucumber** (optional), and **feta**. Add **lemon vinaigrette, salt**, and **pepper** to taste and stir until fully combined.
2. Plate the herby butter bean salad and top with charred cabbage and chicken (if preparing). Garnish the cabbage (and chicken, if applicable) with a dollop of **herbed crème fraîche sauce** and top with **dill** and **black pepper**. Serve with freshly baked **buttermilk biscuits** on the side (optional).

LEMONY WHITE FISH

WITH CRÈME FRAÎCHE BUTTER BEANS & CHARRED BABY GEMS

Makes 2 servings

Ingredients

Prepped Ingredients

Herbed Crème Fraîche Sauce (Page 9)^{134s}

Simple Lemon Vinaigrette (Page 7)^{14s}

Buttermilk Biscuits (see The Dessert Menu 'Buttermilk Biscuits')^{134s}

Lemony White Fish

2 (4 oz) White Fish Fillets

Olive Oil

Kosher Salt

½ Lemon, thinly sliced

3-4 Tbsp cold Salted Butter, broken into small chunks

1-2 pinches of chopped Dill

Crème Fraîche Beans & Charred Baby Gems

Olive Oil, *for cooking*

2 hearts of Baby Gem Lettuce, sliced in half

Remaining chopped and blanched Sugar Snap Peas

15 oz can (about 1 ½ cups) rinsed and strained

Butter Beans

Remaining Herbed Crème Fraîche Sauce

Simple Lemon Vinaigrette, *to taste*

Chopped Chives

¼ to ⅓ cup crumbled Feta Cheese

Flaky or Kosher Salt

Freshly Ground Black Pepper

Accompaniments

2 freshly baked Buttermilk Biscuits (optional)

Instructions

Prepare the Lemony White Fish

1. Preheat your oven to 400°F.
2. Place the **white fish fillets** on a parchment-lined baking sheet and pat dry with a paper towel. Lightly coat with **olive oil** and a generous pinch of **salt**.
3. Top each fillet with **3 lemon slices**, followed by 3-4 small chunks of **butter**. Sprinkle a small pinch of **chopped dill** directly over the lemon slices and bake for 11-12 minutes.

Hot Tip: While fish bakes, prepare the charred baby gems.

Prepare the Charred Baby Gems & Butter Beans

1. Heat a few glugs of **olive oil** in a large sauté pan over high heat. Once the oil is hot, add the **baby gem lettuce**, *cut side facing down*.
2. Sear, undisturbed for 1 ½ to 2 minutes until slightly charred. Remove from the pan and plate, *cut side facing up*. Set aside.
3. In the same skillet, add a few more glugs of oil. Add the **snap peas**, and a pinch of **salt**. Once the snap peas are slightly charred, reduce the heat to low and add in the **butter beans**, a pinch of salt, **pepper**, and the **herbed crème fraîche sauce**. Stir until well combined and cook until heated through.

Assemble the Final Dish

1. Top charred baby gem with **lemon vinaigrette**, **chives**, **feta**, and **flaky salt** and **pepper**. Plate alongside the crème fraîche butter beans.
2. Place baked fish directly on top of the beans, and serve with freshly baked **buttermilk biscuits** (optional) on the side

BUTTERMILK BRINE

Makes about $\frac{3}{4}$ cup

Ingredients

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup Buttermilk
1 clove of Garlic
1 Tbsp chopped Dill
1 Tbsp chopped Chives
1 tsp Kosher Salt
 $\frac{1}{2}$ tsp White Cane Sugar

Instructions

1. Add **all ingredients** to a blender or food processor and blend until fully combined.

To Store: Transfer the brine to an air-tight container and store in the refrigerator.

SIMPLE LEMON VINAIGRETTE

Makes about ½ cup

Ingredients

½ cup Extra Virgin Olive Oil
1 clove of Garlic
Juice of 1 ½ Lemons
1 ½ Tbsp Honey
1 Tbsp White Wine Vinegar
1 tsp Dijon Mustard
½ tsp Kosher Salt

Instructions

1. Place **olive oil** and **garlic** in a microwave-safe container and microwave for 15-20 seconds until the garlic is slightly soft and fragrant.
2. Transfer the olive oil and garlic to a blender with the **remaining ingredients** and blend until fully combined.

To Store: Transfer the vinaigrette to an air-tight container and store in the refrigerator for later use.

BOURSIN BUTTER

Makes about ½ cup

Ingredients

1 block of Garlic & Chives Boursin Cheese

5 Tbsp Unsalted Butter

1 clove of Garlic, grated

Instructions

Prepare the Boursin Cream Sauce

1. Crumble the **Boursin** into a small mixing bowl and set aside.
2. In a small saucepan, heat **butter** until melted. Add **garlic** and cook until fragrant, about 15-20 seconds.
3. Pour the garlic butter directly over the boursin cheese and whisk until smooth and fully combined.

To Store: Transfer the butter to an air-tight container and store in the refrigerator for later use.

To Reheat the Boursin Butter...

1. Place the instructed amount of cream sauce in a microwave-safe container and microwave until heated through, about 30-45 seconds.
2. Transfer the mixture to a mixing bowl and whisk until smooth.

HERBED CRÈME FRAÎCHE SAUCE

Makes about $\frac{3}{4}$ cup

Ingredients

$\frac{1}{2}$ cup Crème Fraîche
 $\frac{1}{4}$ cup Buttermilk
2 Tbsp chopped Chives
1 Tbsp chopped Dill
1 tsp Kosher Salt
1 tsp Lemon Juice
 $\frac{1}{4}$ tsp Black Pepper
 $\frac{1}{4}$ tsp White Cane Sugar

Instructions

1. Place **all ingredients** in a small mixing bowl, and whisk until well combined.

To Store: Transfer the sauce to an air-tight container and store in the refrigerator for later use.

PEPPERCORN MARINADE

Makes about $\frac{2}{3}$ cup

Ingredients

2 Tbsp Black Peppercorns
½ cup Olive Oil or Neutral
2 Tbsp White Wine Vinegar
1 ½ Tbsp Dijon Mustard
1 ½ tsp Kosher Salt
½ tsp White Cane Sugar

Instructions

1. Place **black peppercorns** in a large plastic bag and crush, using a rolling pin or the bottom of a heavy skillet.
2. Transfer the crushed black peppercorns to a mixing bowl with the **remaining ingredients**. Whisk until well combined.

To Store: Transfer the marinade to an air-tight container and store in the refrigerator for later use.